

Old Testament





About the Course

Students in Grades 3-6 read Old Testament narratives chronologically. For 2026-2027 students read selections of Joshua, Judges, Ruth, and 1-2 Samuel. Lesson plans also include selections from maps and books such as The New Manners and Customs of Bible Times, which teachers can read or share with their students to help understand the biblical context and gain insight into the culture and geography of Israel.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Bible: Grade 3, Bible: Grades 4-6



Placement & Combining Tips

Suitable for older students if combining lessons, and ideal for older students just getting familiar with the Bible.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
3-6	Old Testament: Grades 3-6 2 times/week 20 min	ESV Large Print Bible The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition The New Manners and Customs of Bible Times

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Bible: Grade 3				
Old Testament: Grades 3-6	New Testament: Grades 3-6	Old Testament: Grades 3-6	New Testament: Grades 3-6	Church History: Grades 1-3
Bible: Grades 4-6				
Old Testament: Grades 3-6	New Testament: Grades 3-6	Old Testament: Grades 3-6	New Testament: Grades 3-6	Church History: Grades 4-6



Planning & Prep

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LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

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Old Testament: Grades 3-6



ESV Large Print Bible



The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition



The New Manners and Customs of Bible Times



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

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Old Testament: Grades 3-6

How To Teach



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Read

- Read the chapter or selection aloud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the students' pace during the lesson, rather than feeling that a particular number of pages must be completed. It is vitally important that teachers not overload students with more material than they can absorb in one sitting.
- Students who have difficulty sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Students with regular difficulty engaging often benefit from having a picture to associate with the story WHILE listening. Feel free to view the artwork during the reading rather than after the narration.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



View

- Optional: Share a piece of fine art that illustrates the story.



Discuss

- Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
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WEEK 1 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 1

Introduction to Joshua

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ INTRO

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Intro to Joshua

→ NOTEBOOK

WEEK 1 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 2

Joshua Commissioned

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook, Student Bible Atlas

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the intro to Joshua from last time?

→ INTRO

Before he died, Moses passed along the leadership of the people of Israel on to Joshua (Deut. 31:7-8). In today's reading, Joshua will speak to the people about entering the Promised Land - the nation of Canaan. As Joshua speaks, he reminds the people of what they should do to have success and blessing. He also says, "Be strong and courageous." As we read, count how many times you hear this phrase or words similar to this.

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Joshua 1:1-18

- How many times did you hear Joshua say "Be strong and courageous?" (4: Verses 6, 7, 9 & 18) Why do you think he repeats this? How do you imagine you would be feeling as a member of Israel about to go into this land you have been waiting to enter for so long?
- Based on verse 9, why should the people not be afraid and *why* could they be strong and courageous? (vs. 9 - "...for the Lord your God is with you...")
- What are the people to do in order to experience success in taking over the land? (See vs. 7 & 8)

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: Student Bible Atlas p.9 Map 4 and Map 5

1. At the end of Deuteronomy, we are told that before he died, Moses "went up from the plains of Moab to Mount Nebo" (Deut. 34:1) and was shown the Promised Land. On Map 4 (the larger map), locate Moab, the Jordan River (Labeled as "R. Jordan") and Canaan.
2. Look at the image in the bottom right-hand corner to see the view from Mount Nebo.
3. Looking at Map 5, locate Mt Nebo and the Jordan River. Follow the arrows to see the direction the Israelites will move forward in the book of Joshua. The Jordan River moves north to south and to the east is a plateau (mostly flat, level ground) and mountains to the left. The people are approaching Canaan from the south. The first move they will have to make is to cross the Jordan River.

→ NOTEBOOK

In your notebook, create a title page for the book of Joshua.



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Draw a picture of Joshua speaking to the Israelites as their new leader. As time and ability allow, write the phrase "Be strong and courageous." Older students might write a short summary of the passage, or a key verse from the passage.

WEEK 2 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 3

Rahab Hides the Spies

 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs of Bible Times

NOTE: Two different options are given for the reading from Manners & Customs. Choose which one best fits the age or the interest of your student(s).

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Joshua is going to send two spies into the land to check it out. Maybe he thought back to how he had once been a spy for Moses!

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Joshua 2:1-24

•Deuteronomy 28:10 says, "And all the peoples of the earth shall see that you are called by the name of the Lord, and they shall be afraid of you." How does what Rahab says and does agree with (or prove) this verse from Deuteronomy? (If needed, see Josh. 2:9-11, 24)

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Rahab's family lived in a house that was part of the walls of Jericho. Read the following passage for an idea of what this may have looked like.

Manners & Customs "Brick Houses"

Younger students: View the illustrations and read p.28 "When the semi-nomadic"- "stone was white." p.30-31 "The flat roof"- "in Matthew 24:17."

Older students, or as time and interest allow: View the illustrations and read p.28-31 "When the semi-nomadic"- "in Matthew 24:17."

WEEK 2 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 4

Crossing the Jordan

 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read in Joshua last time?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Joshua 3:7-17; 4:15-24

•How would the stones help the children (or future generations) remember what happened at the Jordan River? If you were there and someone asked you what the stones were for, what would you answer?

•Look at verse 24 again. Why did God lead the Israelites across the Jordan River, as he had done for them at the Red Sea?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of today's passage. Older students may pick a key verse or phrase from today's reading to write as well.



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WEEK 3 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 5

The Walls Fall

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

1. Israel celebrates Passover and remembers how God had delivered them from Egypt
Read Joshua 5:10-15

• In verse 12, it says the manna stopped. Why was manna provided in the first place and who provided it? (Exodus 16) Why do they no longer need the manna? (Joshua 5:11-12)

2. Read Joshua 6:1-19

Jericho is the first city the Israelites need to conquer as Jericho protects the entry into the land from the east where they crossed the Jordan. Scholars say Jericho "was about a twelve-acre site...[and] Based on the size of the site today, it seems that it might have taken Joshua's army less than half an hour to march around the city walls...In the ancient world every war was holy war because people believed that their gods called them to war, led them in battle, and fought on their behalf...For this assault it was the ark and the priests that gave indication of God's presence with the Israelites and made it plain that the battle belonged to the Lord." (Bible Story Handbook, Walton) Usually when an army defeated a city or people, they would take the plunder or goods (such as jewelry and anything that was worth a lot). In this case, the people did not take anything, because it wasn't them that claimed the victory - it was God who won this battle.

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Sound of the Shofar

View the video showing various Jewish people blowing the shofar, the ram's horn trumpet that was used in Israel's history - and is still used today to call people to worship. What would it have been like to hear this sound if you were part of the army marching around Jericho?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of what you read today. Older students might write out a key verses from this passage or write a longer summary.

WEEK 3 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 6

Achan's Sin

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

NOTE: The teacher may choose to either read out loud to the student(s) or summarize the reading from Manners & Customs which has to do with warfare and religion. If reading, the couple sentences that may not be appropriate may be skipped.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Last time, we saw that the people did not take any of the plunder from Jericho as they were directed by God: "But all silver and gold, and every vessel of bronze and iron, are holy to the Lord; they shall go into the treasury of the Lord." (6:19) The word "plunder" means the valuables or possessions that would be taken from the people defeated in war. Armies who won battles would take the plunder to not only

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview verses 24 and 25 where Achan and his family are killed because of his disobedience.

Preview Manners & Customs reading regarding warfare. Either summarize or skip the couple sentences that may not be appropriate for younger students.



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celebrate the victory, but to add the loot to their money pile so they could afford to keep battling! After the battle at Jericho, everyone followed this rule and listened...except Achan.

→ READ & NARRATE

Joshua 7:1-25

"When Achan took goods as plunder, it was like making a claim that the Israelites had won the battle rather than the Lord."

→ READ & DISCUSS

Manners & Customs of the Bible "War and religion" (See note above)
p.268-269 "It was not"- "his own people."

WEEK 4 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 7

Tricked

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Two events happen in today's passage. Do you recall what genre the book of Joshua is? (Historical narrative) In a narrative (story), events are told as though someone is asking, "And then what happened?"

First, Joshua renews the covenant that God had given to Moses. Do you remember what God promised Moses? (Deut.28 - if you follow and obey God, then you will be blessed. If you do not follow or obey God, then you will be cursed and things will not go well.)

As we read the story, we might ask, "And then what happened?"

Next, some kings in the land of Canaan come up with a sneaky plan to trick the Israelites. In this context a "king is the ruler of a single city," and these cities were starting to worry about the Israelites. Why do you think they were worried?

→ READ & NARRATE

Joshua 8:30-9:15

•Why do you think it is good for Joshua to renew the covenant God had made with Moses and remind the people what God had said?

•The Gibeonites dressed in old clothes and brought stale food to try to give the impression that they had traveled from a faraway land. Unfortunately, Joshua and the Israelites "did not ask counsel from the Lord" (9:14). Now they are in a treaty with people from the land of Canaan. What do you think will happen?

WEEK 4 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 8

The Sun Stands Still

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The Gibeonites have tricked Joshua, but he will remain faithful to the treaty he made with them. Five kings in the land of Canaan decide to come fight against the Gibeonites because now they are all getting worried at the strength of Gibeon and of the Israelites. Next the historical narrative book of Joshua will answer the question, "And then what happened?"

→ READ & NARRATE



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Joshua 9:16-21; 10:1-14

→ VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Image Link: Joshua Commanding the Sun to Stand Still Upon Gibeon

•What do you notice about this painting? Do you see the people and do you see Joshua? What do you notice in the sky?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw or write a short summary in your notebook about today's reading. Older students may chose a key verse or write a longer summary.

WEEK 5

20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 9

Conquering the Land

📖 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Student Bible Atlas

NOTE: Today's reading will cover three chapters, but will skip verses for time's sake.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Today's reading covers three chapters of information of Joshua and the Israelites defeating various kings in Canaan. These stories of Israel conquering the Promised Land point to God's might and power in fighting for his people, Israel. They are in covenant with him. Do you remember what the word "covenant" means? (A promise.) Because God *is* faithful, he will *be* faithful.

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Today's reading is in two parts:

1. Joshua 10:42-43 •Who did the fighting for Israel and what is happening as a result? (All the kings are being captured.)
2. Eventually Israel captures all the kings and they will have some rest from fighting. While there were many kings that were defeated, we will read just one of the lists of their names.
11:23; 12:7-24

→ MAP

📖 Map Resource: Student Bible Atlas p.10 Map 6

Look at the map and note the red dashed line. What does the map key state this red line shows? (Area permanently controlled by Israel.) Do you recognize any of the names of cities on the map that you have heard or read about?

WEEK 5

20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 10

Dividing the Land

📖 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Student Bible Atlas; notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Joshua chapter 13 all the way through chapter 21 lists out how Joshua divided up the land between the tribes of Israel. After all, the book of Joshua "shows how God kept his covenant promise to give the land to Israel. He prepared them to enter Canaan, sent his commander to lead them, provided aid in battles, distributed the land, and renewed the covenant. The division of land, though not much of a story, is an incredible climax of the process that had brought the Israelites from their slavery in Egypt to the land that God had promised to Abraham through the covenant made



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over four centuries earlier. This is fulfillment of covenant promise on a grand scale." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ & NARRATE

Our reading will be in three parts:

1. Read Joshua 14:1-5
 2. Read 16:1-10 Chapter 16 is an example of what these chapters list as far as boundaries of the inherited land that each tribe received. Other chapters define the boundary of the other tribes' lands.
 3. Read Joshua 21:43-45 These verses give a summary of the purpose of the entire book of Joshua. They could be called the Key Verses or Main Verses of the book.
- How would you summarize the purpose of the book of Joshua according to these verses?

→ READ

📍 Map Resource: Student Bible Atlas, p.11 Map 7 "Dividing the Land"

Find the area that was given to the tribe of Ephraim on the map that you read about in chapter 16. Locate the Jordan River. Why would it be good to have your land inheritance touch water?

→NOTEBOOK

As time and ability allow, copy down all or part of the verses as shown here that state the purpose of the book of Joshua. Younger students might copy down just one or two phrases, older students might copy down a few phrases or the entire selection.

Joshua 21:43-35: "Thus the Lord gave to Israel all the land...And they took possession of it, and they settled there. And the Lord gave them rest on every side...The Lord had given all their enemies into their hands. Not one word of all the good promises that the Lord had made to the house of Israel had failed; all came to pass."

WEEK 6

📅 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 11

Joshua Gets Ready for Goodbye

📖 Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook; Manners & Customs of Bible Times

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

In the first verse of today's reading, Joshua states that he is now old. He gives the first of two speeches to the people of Israel. Imagine you are Joshua, what would you think would be important to tell the people in one of your last speeches you will ever be able to give them?

→ READ & NARRATE

Joshua 23:1-15

→ READ & NARRATE

Although the people were moving into a land where some cities had walls and homes built (as we read about Jericho), tents were also still used at this time. Read the passages on tents and dwellings, and view the images on p.25 about how a tent was erected.

Manners & Customs "Dwellings" p.20-21 "There are two"-"Ahab for this reason."
"The Tent" p.24-26 "The tent of"-"door of the leader."



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→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a sentence about today's reading. Older students may draw, write a summary or copy down a key verse (or more!) from Joshua's speech.

WEEK 6 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 12

Meeting at Shechem

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The first part of today's reading might make you think, "Hm, I feel like I've heard this before." God is speaking through Joshua to remind the people of Israel about their history. The story is given using the personal pronoun of "I", which is used 18 times in these verses. "I took...I gave...I sent...I plagued...I brought...I delivered, etc." Speaking in the first person (by repeatedly using the word "I") in the telling of the history, God reminds the people who won the battles thus far and who had brought them to where they are today as a people. "God reviewed the marvelous deeds he had performed for Israel's benefit...From first to last Israel's conquests, deliverances, and prosperity were because of God's good mercies and were not of their own making." (The Bible Knowledge Commentary)

"Now therefore" begins verse 14. The word "therefore" is an adverb that means "as a result", or "for that reason." In other words, the people had been reminded of God's leading, and now - as a result of that - they had a decision to make. Read the passage and see what it is they have to choose.

→ READ & NARRATE

Joshua 24:1-15

- Who had brought the people of Israel to where they now stood? (God)
- Because God had brought them that far in their story (or history), what choice did they now need to make?
- What do you think their response will be? (We will find out what their actual response was in our next reading.)

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw or write a summary of today's reading. Older students may write a longer summary or write down a key verse from the passage.

Alternative Option: As time allows, a short summary of the entire book of Joshua can be written or discussed out loud. Questions could include: What happened in Joshua? Were the people following God? What was Joshua like as a leader?

WEEK 7 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 13

The Choice

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

We are coming to the end of the book of Joshua. Overall, the people have obeyed and followed after God in the book of Joshua. And, according to Deuteronomy 28, what will be the result of following after God? (The people will receive blessings in the form of having land, fruitful crops, lots of kids or growth of their nation, and things will go well for them.) Did they receive blessings as Joshua has led them into Canaan? In what way(s)? (Conquered enemies, inherited actual land for their tribes,



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food to eat - no more manna, etc.)

→ READ & NARRATE

Joshua 24:16-33

•The people respond right away to Joshua when he tells them they have a choice to make. How do they respond? (vs. 16-18)
However, Joshua "was not at all satisfied" with their answer and challenges them on it. Eventually, he tells them exactly what they need to do. "He had heard the pledge on their lips; now he challenged them to prove their sincerity by their works...There could be no mixing of allegiance to God with idol-worship. A firm choice had to be made then as in every generation." (Bible Knowledge Commentary) At the end of the passage, Joshua - as the final act of his leadership of Israel - renews the covenant between God and the people. God would bless them if they followed him, and they would be cursed if they did not follow him.

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of Joshua renewing the covenant at Shechem. Older students may write down a key verse or write a longer summary of the back-and-forth of Joshua and the people.

WEEK 7 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 14

Judges Begins

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

While the Israelites followed God as they entered Canaan, there were little seeds of disobedience showing up throughout the book of Joshua. Now, in the book of Judges, unfortunately those seeds grow into full disobedience. The book tells the history of Israel over centuries, but the book also wanted to encourage the Israelites to obey and be faithful to God.

The word "judges" might remind us of a courtroom, however, at this time in history, the judges were "tribal or national leaders. Often they were military commanders." They would settle arguments and give advice to the people of their territory. "Since Israel had no king or other central political figure, the judges played an important role in Israel's survival." (Basic Bible Commentary)

Sadly, as the book continues on the Israelite's turn further and further away from God and things are very dark and rather disturbing. Throughout the book, certain judges will be introduced and we will focus on their stories.

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 1:27-36; 2:1-10

•One bad choice Israel made is not driving out the Canaanites completely and now things start to spiral downward. In 2:10 what does it say the new generation knew about what God had done for them? (Nothing.) How would you imagine Joshua (if he was alive at that time) would feel about this?

→ NOTEBOOK

Turn to a new page to create a title page for the book of Judges. Write the title of the book, and what genre it is: Historical Narrative. Draw a picture or write a short summary of the passage. Older students may write a longer summary or write down key verse(s) of the passage, including 2:10.



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WEEK 8 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 15

Cycles

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The Israelites have started worshipping false idols and have turned away from following God. And now a cycle (or a series of events that keep repeating) will start that will happen throughout the book of Judges. "The cycles (disobedience, punishment, cry for help, deliverance) show how God demonstrated his power and mercy by delivering his people time after time after his justice had demanded that he bring punishment." (Bible Story Handbook) Sadly, it is also obvious that the leaders of the Israelites are just as bad as the people. In the cycle, the punishment they experienced was in the form of oppression, being conquered by an enemy or even being enslaved.

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 2:11-23

WEEK 8 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 16

Othniel

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

NOTE: There are two options for the reading today. For the second option of reading (3:7-26), preview the passage as there is an instance of violence as King Eglon gets stabbed. However, the story is also a great example of the humanity included in the Bible.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Today's reading introduces the first judge, Othniel. Recall that there are cycles in the book of Judges that involve disobedience, punishment, cry for help, deliverance. Each time that cycle happens, their decline into disobedience, idolatry and sin is even worse. As we read, listen for those steps in the cycle.

→ READ & NARRATE

Younger Students: Judges 3:7-15

Older Students: Judges 3:7-26

→ NOTEBOOK

∞ Image Link: Cycle of Judges

Draw and/or label the cycle that is in the book of Judges. You can come up with your own words or use the following for the steps of the cycle: disobedience, punishment, cry for help, deliverance. An example is given at the link (Your chart/cycle does not need to look exactly like this!) Older students can put verse numbers from today's reading about Othniel next to each step (i.e. Disobedience 3:7)



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WEEK 9 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 17

Deborah and Barak

- Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs
- Materials: Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Today's reading will introduce us to the next judge in Israel's history. The judges "were often as bad as the people. Deborah was certainly an exception to this, as she was a faithful prophetess and brought deliverance in association with the commander Barak...Deborah was first and foremost a prophetess, one who brought God's word to the people. People came to her for decisions because she would inquire of God for them. It is likely that in this particular instance they came to ask God what they should do about the Canaanite armies. She responded by sending for Barak and giving him God's orders." (Bible Story Handbook)

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 4:1-15

→ READ & NARRATE

Over the next couple lessons, we will read a few passages from Manners & Customs to learn more about how the armies and groups fought at this time of the Old Testament.

"The horse" p.213 "The horses of" - "back to Jezreel."

p.145 "Iron was originally" - "for the Temple."

Optional: As interest or time allows, the entire passage regarding workers with metal could be read. This gives a short history of the development of metal being used in the times of the Old Testament p.143-145 "workers of metal"

WEEK 9 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 18

Deborah's Song

- Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Sisera went into battle confidently, knowing the Israelites were outnumbered and would seemingly be easily to conquer. But God used both human means (the swords of the Israelites) and divine to defeat the Canaanites. Today's passage is a victory hymn written by Deborah. In it, we see further information as to the divine means God used to crush Sisera by sending a sudden flood to the Kishon River.

→ READ & NARRATE

Younger students: 5:1-15, 20-21

Older students: Judges 5:1-31

• In verses 20 and 21, torrent refers to a flood of waters that overtook the army. If you were driving in chariots, how would a sudden flood of a river slow you down?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture of Deborah, Barak or the battle they fought against Sisera or write a short summary. Older students may write a longer summary, or copy key verses



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down.

Optional: Try writing a short victory song or poem celebrating the victory of Israel over Sisera.

WEEK 10 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 19

Gideon

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The Israelites experienced peace for 40 years under Deborah's judgeship (5:31b), but then their cycle of disobedience began again and they were conquered by the Midianites. Let's ask the question that the books of Historical Narrative answer: And then what happened?

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 6:1-4; 11-24

- How did Gideon respond when the angel of the Lord spoke to him?

→ READ, VIEW & DISCUSS

∞ Image Link: Terebinth tree

1. View the image of the terebinth tree, a relative of the oak tree.
2. The Midianites were a semi-nomadic tribe, which means they traveled from place to place at times. So they liked to attack when the crops had been recently harvested (vs. 3-5).

Manners & Customs "The Gezer Calendar" and "Grain crops" p.86-90 (Skip p.88-89)

"By the time"-"...for warmer days."

"Threshing" p.94 "The separation of"-"...to his enemies."

- Take a couple minutes to look at the schoolboy's calendar in the text box labeled "The Gezer Calendar" If you live in an area where crops are grown, how does your area's calendar match this ancient calendar?

WEEK 10 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 20

Gideon and Tests

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

In today's reading there are a few tests that take place. First of all, Gideon uses "the dew and the fleece for an oracle. In an oracle, a yes-or-no question was posed to deity, and some mechanism was designated for deity to answer...Since God had already sent an angel to tell him that he was supposed to lead the armies into battle, Gideon wanted to check to see if those orders were still in place." Once the normal result happened, Gideon flipped it because he still doubted. "So with great apology (appropriate, since God had already given instruction), he then asked for the indicator to be switched; having the fleece dry and the threshing floor wet. This does indeed show a lack of faith on his part." (Bible Story Handbook) The second tests have to do with how the warriors drink from the water. Gideon once again was being asked to put his faith in God going before the Israelites to fight their enemies.

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 6:25-40; 7:1-11

(In order to keep the story together, today's reading is a little longer than usual. If

Old Testament: Grades 3-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1	
additional time is needed to finish today's reading, the next lesson time can be used.) → NOTEBOOK Draw a picture or write a short summary of today's reading. Older students may write a longer summary or choose one or two main verses from the passage to copy into their notebooks.	
WEEK 11 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 21 Catch Up → CATCH UP Use this time to catch up on the reading in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.	
WEEK 11 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 22 Catch Up → CATCH UP Use this time to catch up on the reading in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.	
WEEK 12 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 23 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from:	
WEEK 12 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 24 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from:	



Term 2

WEEK 1 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 25

Gideon's Battle

- Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs
- Materials: Manners & Customs p.17 Text box titled "The Priest's Clothing"

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Gideon has his army put together to go up against the Midianites. Today we will read about that battle.

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 7:15b-18 (begin at "And he returned..."); 19-23; 8:22-27; 33-35
•How did the Israelites respond after Gideon died? (vs.33-35)

→ READ & NARRATE

"In the ancient world around Israel, just as the gods were fed (sacrifices) and housed (temples) they were also clothed (that is, the images were). It is possible that Gideon's ephod represented the clothing of Yahweh (not on an actual image) just as the ark was the footstool of Yahweh's throne." (Bible Story Handbook) The ephod could be used as an oracle to discern God's will. In this sense, this particular ephod was idolatrous and inappropriate.

Optional: Turn back to p.12-13 to look at the images of typical clothing during Bible times.

WEEK 1 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 26

The Cycle of Judges

- Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

After Gideon, there was another 40 years of peace for the people of Israel. But sadly, the cycle begins again.

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 10:6-18

- When strong enemies came up against them the Israelites tended to turn toward those peoples' gods. What happens when they start worshipping these gods? (vs.6 "And they forsook the Lord and did not serve him.)
- Open your notebook to the drawing you did of the cycle of Israel in the book of Judges. What parts of today's reading fits into the chart?

WEEK 2 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 27

The Birth of Samson

- Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The cycles in the book of Judges "show how God demonstrated his power and mercy



Term 2

by delivering them time after time after his justice had demanded that he bring punishment." Samson is the next judge of Israel and he is "worse than all the other judges as he pursued his own...personal agendas, yet God still used him to deliver the Israelites." (Bible Story Handbook) In the Bible, Samson, who we will meet today, and Samuel, who we will meet later in the year's readings, are the only two where the Nazirite vow extends to someone's entire lifetime. Typically, the vow was taken for a specific, limited time to show a high devotion to dedication.

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 13:1-20; 24-25

WEEK 2 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 28

Honey from a Lion

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

As we begin Judges 14, Samson is now grown up. He wants to marry a woman from the Philistines, but he is to be a deliverer of the Israelites, is it a good idea for him to marry a Philistine woman?

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 14:5-19

• "In ancient literature, kings and heroes were sometimes portrayed as killing a lion. While this episode fits a standard heroic feat, it also demonstrates Samson's disregard for his vow, as he did not hesitate to scoop honey from the corpse of the lion." (Bible Story Handbook) After reading this passage, what do you notice about Samson and how he acts or behaves? Does he fit your idea of a hero?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture of today's passage or write a short summary. Older students may write a longer summary or copy down a couple main verses from the reading.

WEEK 3 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 29

Samson's Revenge Against Philistines

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs

Materials: Manners & Customs p.260-262 "Warfare is an"-no standing army."

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 15:1; 3-20

→ READ & NARRATE

The passage from Manners & Customs in the Bible we will read today is a summary of warfare before there was a monarchy (kings over the entire nation of Israel), including some battles we have read about this year in Joshua, Judges and now into First Samuel.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview today's passage for sensitive content regarding Samson's wife, her dad's offer of her sister, and the Philistine's subsequent reaction by burning up her and her father.



Term 2

WEEK 3 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 30

Delilah Manipulates Samson

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

NOTE: The following note may be helpful if any questions arise from today's reading where in verse 15:20, it states that the "Lord had left him."

"In the Old Testament, the Spirit of the Lord was usually seen in empowering people to a task. Today we talk of the Spirit's indwelling people when they become Christians. These are very different things, and therefore this incident in Judges should not be viewed as the beginning of Samson's spiritual relationship with God. The endowment of the Spirit here had to do with his role as general." (Bible Story Handbook) Samson's choices are selfish, and yet God continues to use him as an instrument to accomplish His will.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Samson meets Delilah, a woman who took a bribe (payment) from the Philistines to help weaken and defeat Samson. She accepts 5,500 shekels of silver, which - in that time - a typical wage would only be about 10 to 12 shekels for an entire year's worth of work! "And then what happened?"

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 16:4-31

• Delilah gets the best of Samson, but in v.28 Samson asks God to give him strength one more time in order to defeat the Philistines. What happens next? And why do you think God gave him strength in this situation?

→ NOTEBOOK

Draw a picture or write a short summary of Samson and Delilah. Older students may write a longer summary, or copy down one or more important verses from this passage.

• EXTRA HELPING

Read p.150-151 in Manners & Customs of Bible Times to find out more about weaving and the loom and pin Delilah used to attempt to defeat Samson.

WEEK 4 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 31

Micah

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Do you recall what genre of books these are that we have been reading? (Historical Narrative) Typically, Historical Narrative books answer the question "and then what happened?" However, in these final chapters of Judges, that pattern changes a bit. These stories are not what happened *next*, rather they tell stories of what happened *during* the time of the judges we have been reading about.

In the final chapters of the book of Judges, no further judges are introduced. "No note of Israel's sin, of outside oppression, of a cry for help, or of God's provision for a hero-judge to save the people. These chapters are simply additional bits of history that the editor apparently did not want to leave out." (Basic Bible Commentary) The stories may have been used to show the moral decay the people had experienced during the time of the judges.

→ READ & NARRATE



Term 2

Let's read the first of the stories in these ending chapters. Micah, whose name (ironically) means "Who is like Yahweh?", is introduced in verse 1. In verse 2, he's going to tell his mom that the money stolen from her was actually taken by him. How do you think his mom will respond to this? Let's read to find out what this mom and son do next.

Judges 17:1-13

- How does the mother respond when Micah gives back the money? What does she make for him and his shrine of gods?
- Exodus 20:3-4: "You shall have no other gods before me. You shall not make for yourself a carved image, or any likeness of anything that is in heaven above, or that is in the earth beneath, or that is in the water under the earth." Are Micah and his mother obeying this rule in the law of Moses? Use information from today's reading to explain your answer. (They made a carved image and metal image; he already had a shrine with other gods.)
- Read 17:6, a key verse of the book of Judges, again. What do you imagine it would be like to live in a land where this was how people were living?

WEEK 4 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 32

The Danites Look for Land

- Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Manners & Customs
- Materials: Manners & Customs

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 18:1-13

Younger Students: p.327 "The dearth of priests"

"When the Jews"- "...breaking the basic commandments."

- Note the picture of the priest on p.326. The ephod is the embroidered garment overlaying his tunic.

Older Students: p.325-327 "The Levites"

"Levi, one of the"- "...breaking the basic commandments."

WEEK 5 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 33

Danites Move the Idols

- Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

Today we will read the second half of the story of the Danites. They have arrived at Micah's house and notice Micah's idols. What do you think they will do with them?

→ READ & NARRATE

Judges 18:14-31

- Why do you think the author takes care to include the fact that the priests of the Danites set up Micah's idols at their new place in v.30-31?



Term 2

WEEK 5 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 34

Naomi and Ruth

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

The book of Judges ends by repeating the sad statement one more time: "In those days there was no king in Israel. Everyone did what was right in his own eyes." Today we will begin the book of Ruth, which begins with a verse saying the story took place while the judges were ruling. Elimelech moves his family away from the city of Bethlehem to Moab because there is a famine. Moabites were an enemy of the people of Israel, but in that land, Ruth, a Moabite woman, marries into Naomi's family and shows faithfulness.

Ruth is a short, four-chapters-long book that shines in the midst of the darkness, because the story of Ruth holds hope. While the book of Judges showed us God can still work through people who were disobedient, foolish and selfish, the book of Ruth shows us what he can do through people who are faithful to him.

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

Ruth 1:1-18

- "Whenever people were forced to leave the covenant Promised Land, it can be construed as either punishment or neglect of God. Since this story is in the judges period when the people were constantly unfaithful, we can infer that the famine was part of God's judgment. Drought and famine were included in the curses for violating the covenant (Deut. 28:23-24)." (Bible Story Handbook)
- What does Ruth choose to do in this passage? How is her loyalty and faithfulness different than what most people were choosing in the book of Judges?

→ NOTEBOOK

Create a title page for the book of Ruth. Draw a picture or write a short summary of today's passage. Older students may write a longer summary or choose to copy down key verse(s) from the reading.

WEEK 6 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 35

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

Ruth 3

WEEK 6 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 36

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO



Term 2

→ READ & NARRATE
Ruth 4

WEEK 7 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 37

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP
What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE
I Samuel 1

WEEK 7 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 38

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP
What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE
I Samuel 2

WEEK 8 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 39

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP
What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE
I Samuel 2:33-36; 3:1-21

WEEK 8 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 40

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP
What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE
I Samuel 4: 1-11; 5:1-12

WEEK 9 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 41

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP
What do you recall about what we read last time?

Old Testament: Grades 3-6

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Term 2

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 7:1-6, 12-17; 8:4-18

WEEK 9 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 42

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 8:19-22; 9:1-27; 10:1

WEEK 10 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 43

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 12

WEEK 10 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 44

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 13:1-23

WEEK 11 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 45

Catch Up

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on the reading in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 11 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 46

Catch Up

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on the reading in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

Old Testament: Grades 3-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 12 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 47
Exam Week

→ EXAMS
Answer question(s) related to the course.
Questions will come from:

WEEK 12 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 48
Exam Week

→ EXAMS
Answer question(s) related to the course.
Questions will come from:

Old Testament: Grades 3-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 49

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 14:1-23

WEEK 1 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 50

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 15

WEEK 2 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 51

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 16:1-13, 20-23

WEEK 2 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 52

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 17:1-58 split

WEEK 3 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 53

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO



Term 3

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 17 split with previous lesson

WEEK 3 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 54

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 18:1-4; 19:1-7, 20:1-20

WEEK 4 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 55

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 20:21-42

WEEK 4 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 56

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

I Samuel 24:1-22; 25:1

WEEK 5 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 57

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel 1:3-4, 11-12; 2:8-11, 5:1-3, 17-21; 6:12-19

WEEK 5 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 58

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?



Term 3

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel 7

WEEK 6 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 59

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel 9:1-13

WEEK 6 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 60

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel 11-12:14

WEEK 7 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 61

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel 15-18 Absalom

WEEK 7 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 62

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel 19

WEEK 8 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 63

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?



Term 3

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel 22 split (include psalms link)

WEEK 8 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 64

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel split in half 22

WEEK 9 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 65

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel 23

WEEK 9 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 66

Materials: ESV Large Print Bible; Notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what we read last time?

→ INTRO

→ READ & NARRATE

2 Samuel 24

WEEK 10 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 67

Materials:

WEEK 10 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 68

Materials:

WEEK 11 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 69

Catch Up

Materials:

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

Old Testament: Grades 3-6

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Term 3

WEEK 11 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 70 Catch Up Materials: → CATCH UP Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.	
WEEK 12 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 71 Materials: EXAM WEEK	
WEEK 12 20m Old Testament: Grades 3-6 - Lesson 72 Materials: EXAM WEEK	